LARKSPUR LANE VETERINARY CLINIC · PET HEALTH BLOG

5 Signs Your Dog Needs a Vet Visit

AI-ASSISTED SAMPLE

Written by Jennevie Javier · About a 4-minute read · Fictional clinic

Dogs can't tell us when something is wrong, but their bodies and habits usually do. The best tool you have is knowing your dog's "normal": how much they eat and drink, how much energy they have, and their bathroom routine. When that normal changes, pay attention.

> **Go to a vet right now, don't wait**, if your dog has a seizure or is staggering, may have eaten something poisonous, is bleeding and it doesn't stop within 5 minutes, has trouble breathing, collapses, or shows signs of heatstroke.

1 Vomiting or diarrhea that keeps happening

One upset stomach after eating something in the yard can happen. But if your dog vomits more than twice in 24 hours, has diarrhea again and again, or you see blood in the vomit or stool, it's time to call the vet. Dogs can get dehydrated quickly when they keep losing fluids.

2 Not eating, not drinking, or no energy

A dog that suddenly skips meals, refuses water, or just lies around when they're usually playful is telling you something. Low energy along with a poor appetite is a common reason vets recommend an exam. A dog that won't drink for a full day needs to be seen right away.

3 Coughing, gagging, or breathing that looks hard

Watch for nonstop coughing or gagging, choking, or breathing that looks like hard work. Breathing trouble is always urgent. Don't wait to see if it passes.

4 Limping, pain, or not wanting to move

Limping that lasts, crying out when touched, not wanting to jump or climb stairs, or holding a leg up are all signs of pain. Dogs often hide pain, so by the time you notice it, it's usually worth a check. If your dog can't put any weight on a leg at all, go in the same day.

5 Trouble peeing or pooping

Straining with little or nothing coming out, crying while going, or blood in the urine needs attention. A dog that can't urinate or pass stool at all, or is clearly in pain while trying, is an emergency. Go in right away.

When in doubt, call

You never need to be sure something is serious before calling your vet. Describing what you see, when it started, and whether your dog is eating and drinking helps the team decide how soon your dog should come in. At Larkspur Lane, you can call us at (217) 555-0142 or book a visit online any time.

This article is general information, not veterinary advice. Every dog is different. If you are worried about your dog, contact your veterinarian.

Sources

- American Veterinary Medical Association (AVMA), "Pet First Aid" client brochure (2025): situations that need immediate veterinary care, including vomiting or diarrhea more than twice in 24 hours and refusing to drink for 24 hours or more.
- VCA Animal Hospitals, "Health Concerns: Diarrhea or Vomiting" (vcahospitals.com/urgent-care/health-concerns/diarrhea-or-vomiting): vomiting more than twice in 24 hours, poor appetite or lethargy, repeated loose stools, or blood in the stool.

AI-assisted sample by Jennevie Javier. Larkspur Lane Veterinary Clinic and its phone number are fictional.